

TAMS MUN I

SEPTEMBER 26, 2026



Delegate Handbook

Rules of Procedure, Position Papers, and Awards

Letter from the Secretaries-General

Dear delegates, advisors, and staff,

It is our genuine pleasure to welcome you to the inaugural session of TAMS Model United Nations.

There is something specific about a first conference. Nothing here is traditional yet. There is no "how we've always done it," no accumulated set of habits about which committee is the prestigious one or which award is the real one. Everything you do this weekend is the first time it has been done here, and some of it will become how it is done from now on. We would ask you to treat that seriously.

We have built four committees around one shared conviction: that the interesting questions in international affairs are the ones where reasonable people disagree for real reasons. Our General Assembly asks where the line between security and liberty actually falls online. Our World Health Assembly asks whether prohibiting a market or supplying it is the more humane response to scarcity. Our Disarmament Committee asks whether the tools that stop proliferation are the same tools that deny developing states technology they are entitled to. And our crisis committee puts fifteen of you in a room on the last ordinary evening of the Soviet Union.

None of those has a correct answer waiting in the background guide. Each has a set of positions that can be argued well or argued badly, and the difference between them is preparation.

A note on what this Secretariat values. We are a school for mathematics and science, and we are running a conference about politics. That is not a contradiction — it is our advantage. Bring the same standard of evidence here that you would bring to a lab report. Know your numbers. Cite the actual treaty rather than the summary of it. Be willing to change your position when someone shows you a better argument, and say so out loud when you do. The delegates who win awards at this conference will be the ones who moved the room, not the ones who talked the longest.

Read your guide. Write your position paper. Come find us if you are lost — every member of this Secretariat would rather answer a question than watch a delegate sit silent.

We are very glad you are here.

Sincerely,

Akshat Gupta and **Aditi Gokhale** Secretaries-General, TAMS Model United Nations ballot.tams@gmail.com

1. Committee slate

GA — General Assembly Plenary. Censorship and Surveillance in the Digital Age. Beginner/Intermediate, ~50 delegations.

WHO — World Health Assembly. The Black Market in Human Organs. Intermediate, ~36 delegations.

DISEC — GA First Committee. Preventing WMD Acquisition by Non-State Actors. Advanced, ~42 delegations.

JCC — State Council of the USSR. The Dissolution of the USSR (opens 18 August 1991). Advanced crisis, 15 positions.

2. Position papers

One page per delegate, per committee. Due two weeks before conference. Required to be eligible for an award.

Submit all position papers to **balot.tams@gmail.com**. Use the subject line **Committee — Country — Delegate Name**.

Structure — three paragraphs:

1. **The problem, from your country's perspective.** What is at stake for *you* specifically? Use one hard number and one domestic fact.
2. **Your country's past actions.** Treaties signed or refused, votes cast, domestic laws, public statements. Cite one real instrument by name.
3. **What you propose.** Two or three concrete measures you will bring to committee.

Formatting: 12 pt, single-spaced, header with delegate name, school, committee, and country. Cite sources in footnotes or a short list — no citation format is mandated, but assertions of fact should be traceable.

What the dais rewards: specificity. "Nigeria supports capacity-building" is worth nothing. "Nigeria's 2019 national 1540 implementation report identifies brokering controls as its principal legislative gap, and Nigeria therefore proposes a regional model brokering statute developed through ECOWAS" is worth a great deal.

AI use policy — set by the Secretaries-General. Position papers must be your own work. Using an AI system to research the topic is fine;

submitting text you did not write is not, and the dais reads for it. State your policy publicly before submissions open so it is not litigated afterward.

3. Rules of Procedure (GA, WHO, DISEC)

Roll call. *Present* — you may abstain on substantive votes. *Present and voting* — you may not.

Setting the agenda (only if a committee has two topics; ours have one, so the dais will open debate directly).

Speakers List. The default state of committee. The dais opens it at the start; motion to *open the Speakers List*, then raise your placard to be added. Speeches run 45–90 seconds. **Yields** at the end of a speech: to another delegate, to questions, or to the chair.

Moderated Caucus. A structured debate on a sub-topic, with the chair calling on speakers.

Motion for a moderated caucus on the funding of national implementation, ten minutes total time, one minute speaking time.

Requires: topic, total time, speaking time. Simple majority.

Unmoderated Caucus. Delegates leave their seats and negotiate freely. This is where working papers get written.

Motion for an unmoderated caucus of fifteen minutes.

Working Paper. An informal draft of ideas. No formatting requirement, no sponsors needed, must be approved by the dais before it is distributed.

Draft Resolution. The formal product. Requires the sponsor/signatory threshold the dais sets (a common rule: sponsors at least 10% of committee, signatories at least 20%; signatories are only saying they want to see it debated, not that they support it). Format:

- A single sentence, grammatically — one long one.
- **Preambulatory clauses** (italicized opener, comma at the end): *Recalling*, *Noting with concern*, *Reaffirming*, *Deeply disturbed*, *Bearing in*

mind. These describe the problem and cite prior action. Never contain new policy.

- **Operative clauses** (numbered, underlined opener, semicolon at the end, period on the last): *Calls upon, Requests, Encourages, Urges, Establishes, Recommends*. These do the work. Note that the GA and WHA can only *recommend* to Member States — a GA resolution that “demands” or “condemns and sanctions” is out of order for a first-time delegate to write and the dais will say so.

Amendments. *Friendly* — all sponsors agree; adopted automatically. *Unfriendly* — debated and voted separately before the resolution.

Voting procedure. Once the chair moves to voting bloc, the room is sealed: no notes, no entry or exit. Procedural votes require no abstention and no substantive debate. Substantive votes on draft resolutions: simple majority of those present and voting.

Motions in order of precedence (highest first): Point of Personal Privilege · Point of Order · Point of Parliamentary Inquiry · Motion to Adjourn/Suspend · Motion to Close Debate · Motion for Moderated/Unmoderated Caucus · Motion to Introduce a Draft Resolution.

Points:

- *Point of Personal Privilege* — you cannot hear, are too cold, need to step out. May interrupt a speaker only for audibility.
- *Point of Order* — the rules are being broken. May not interrupt.
- *Point of Parliamentary Inquiry* — a question about procedure, never about substance.

Diplomatic courtesy. Speak in third person about your country (“the Republic of Kenya believes”), never “I.” No personal attacks. No breaking character.

4. What earns an award

Ranked in the order this Secretariat weighs them:

1. **Moving the committee forward** — building consensus, merging blocs, finding the compromise that unblocks a room.
2. **Substantive accuracy** — knowing your coun-

try’s actual position and the actual instruments.

3. **Authorship** — writing clauses, not just standing behind them.
4. **Speaking well** — clear, brief, responsive to what was just said.

What does **not** earn an award: dominating the Speakers List, sponsoring a resolution you did not write, aggression toward other delegates, or being loud in unmods.

5. Additional rules for Crisis (JCC)

No Speakers List by default. Debate runs in moderated caucus almost continuously, punctuated by crisis updates from the Crisis Director.

Directives replace resolutions:

- **Public directive** — an action taken by the committee as a body, debated and voted (simple majority). Written as numbered operative clauses, no preambulatory clauses, signed by sponsors.
- **Personal / private directive** — a note sent to the crisis backroom describing an action you take using your own portfolio’s resources. Not debated, not voted, not public. Format: what you are doing, with what resources, who else is involved, and what outcome you expect. *Be specific — vague directives fail.*
- **Communiqués** — messages to outside parties (a foreign government, a military district, a newspaper).

Portfolio powers. Every action must be traceable to something your character actually commands. The dais will reject directives that assume powers you do not have.

Crisis notes should be short. Three to six sentences. A page-long scheme will get a worse outcome than a paragraph the backroom can act on immediately.

Character, not caricature. You may depart from what your historical figure actually did — that is the point of an alternate-history crisis — but you must depart from it *for reasons your character would have*.

6. Conference logistics checklist (Secretariat)

Registration platform open; school caps set; country assignment method decided (first-come vs. application)

Background guides published no later than **six weeks** before conference

Dais staff recruited and trained: 2 per GA committee (Chair + Director), 3–4 for crisis

ROP training session run for all staff — mock committee, not a slide deck

Position paper deadline published with the

guides (address: ballot.tams@gmail.com)

Rooms booked with placard-visible sightlines; crisis room needs a separate backroom space

Printing: placards, resolution copies, awards, delegate badges

Awards decided: Best Delegate, Outstanding Delegate, Honorable Mention (+ Best Position Paper per committee)

Accessibility, dietary, and emergency contact information collected at registration

Faculty advisor and UNT/TAMS administrative approvals confirmed